

The Silver Mouse

(**Mandarins** were high Chinese officials a long time ago. They were held in great respect and fear by the common people. The Chinese also have a custom of naming each year after a particular animal. The following story relates to this.)



A highly **revered** mandarin of Shenzen was about to retire. He was considered highly because he had never been seen taking a **bribe** throughout his career as a mandarin, as other mandarins did.

The grateful people of Shenzen decided to present him a **farewell** gift. But they were **afraid** to **approach** him directly. Instead, they went to his wife and asked her what she thought would **please** her husband.

"Since you are so **eager** to give him a gift, any **curio** would **delight** him," she replied.

"Ah, that is a wonderful idea, Madam!" **exclaimed** the men. "In what year was the great mandarin born, if we may respectfully ask you?"

"In the year of the Mouse. Why?" she said.

"We shall offer him a large **replica** of a mouse in silver," the men replied.

The mandarin's wife accepted the silver mouse without **daring** to let her husband know.

A few years later, the wife was **obliged** to **break up** the silver mouse and sell the pieces one by one because they had fallen on hard times. The mandarin came to know of it and asked her where she'd got the mouse.

When the wife **fearfully** told him the whole story, he **sighed**, instead of getting angry.

“My poor woman! You should have told them I was born in the year of the Buffalo!”

@mocks_wallah

Vocabulary

1. **Mandarin** (noun) – A high-ranking official or bureaucrat in ancient China. उच्च चीनी अधिकारी
2. **Revered** (adjective) – respected, venerated, esteemed, honored, admired सम्मानित
3. **Bribe** (noun) – payoff, inducement, backhander, graft, hush money रिश्वत
4. **Farewell** (noun) – parting, valediction, , goodbye, leave-taking विदाई
5. **Afraid** (adjective) – fearful, scared, apprehensive, hesitant, timid भयभीत/ डरा हुआ
6. **Approach** (verb) – come to, contact, reach out to, go to, petition संपर्क करना
7. **Please** (verb) – satisfy, gratify, delight, appease, gladden प्रसन्न करना
8. **Eager** (adjective) – keen, enthusiastic, ardent, zealous, avid उत्सुक
9. **Curio** (noun) – a rare, unusual, or intriguing object दुर्लभ सजावटी वस्तु
10. **Delight** (verb) – please, charm, gladden, elate, enchant आनंदित करना
11. **Exclaim** (verb) – cry out, shout, call out, burst out, proclaim खुशी से चिल्लाना
12. **Replica** (noun) – copy, reproduction, duplicate, model, facsimile प्रतिकृति
13. **Dare** (verb) – risk, venture, have the nerve to, presume, be bold to हिम्मत करना
14. **Oblige** (verb) – compel, force, necessitate, constrain, require मजबूर होना
15. **Break up** (phrasal verb) – dismantle, disassemble, break apart, fragment, smash up टुकड़े-टुकड़े करना
16. **Fearfully** (adverb) – timidly, anxiously, nervously, apprehensively, with trepidation डरते-डरते
17. **Sigh** (verb) – exhale, heave a sigh, breathe out, groan softly, lament गहरी सांस लेना



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